Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers of the Town Hall on Monday, February 24, 2020 at 7:00 p.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:02 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

Councillor Bower re-declared a pecuniary interest with respect to Item 7.2 General Government Committee – Operating Budget Report as a family member is employed by the Town of Ajax in the Recreation, Culture and Community Development Department.

Mayor Collier re-declared a pecuniary interest with respect to Item 7.2 General Government Committee – Operating Budget Report as a family member is employed by the Town of Ajax in the Recreation, Culture and Community Development Department.

3. Adoption of Minutes

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of Council held on January 27, 2020 be adopted.
CARRIED

4. Question Period

None.

5. Delegation and Petitions/Public Hearings

None.

6. Correspondence

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the report dated February 24, 2020 containing Items of Correspondence be adopted.
CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated February 10, 2020 be adopted.

CARRIED

With consent of all Members, Departmental Report Items 7.4.3 Winter Control – 2020 Operating Budget NEPI Explanation and 7.4.4 Community Safety Resources were brought forward.

7.4.3 Winter Control – 2020 Operating Budget NEPI Explanation

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Option A – Contracted Service & Additional Staff (Hybrid service delivery model) as per the New / Expanded Programs and Initiative Form be approved.

CARRIED

7.4.4 Community Safety Resources

Members asked if the opportunity to add staffing to support the Town's Community Safety portfolio could be revisited in the future, if warranted. CAO Baker noted that staff will monitor the situation and bring any need for increased resources to the attention of Council.

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the report titled 'Community Safety Resources' be received for information.

CARRIED

7.2 General Government Committee Report

General Government Committee – Operating Budget – February 3, 2020

Mayor Collier relinquished the Chair in order to bring forward amendments to Item 7.2. General Government Committee – Operating Budget Report. Deputy Mayor Dies assumed the Chair.

Members asked questions regarding the IMPACT Ajax program and Community Development portfolio, staffing, budget, intake processes, and metrics, and sought clarification on the timing of a new part time Community Development Assistant staff request prior to the forthcoming review of the IMPACT Ajax Program, identified as an action item within the Strategic Plan.

T. Vaughan, Director of Recreation, Culture and Community Development responded to questions and discussed a planned expansion of the IMPACT Ajax program to include three new streams (sports, festivals and events, and arts and culture) and the anticipated staff impact to administer such streams. She provided a detailed history and overview of the community development portfolio in supporting capacity building for community groups and not-for-profit organizations, for which demand has increased steadily and noted that a comprehensive review of the IMPACT Ajax program could be presented in tandem with the annual update report to Council in the spring.

R. Gruber, Manager of Community & Cultural Development, shared details on IMPACT Ajax program information Cafés and intake process, noting that approved projects become fee-for-service agreements, requiring staff oversight.

Members asked if the staffing request could be revisited after the comprehensive program review, if warranted. CAO Baker confirmed that the detailed review could identify increased staffing needs.

Main Motion

That the General Government Committee Operating Budget Report dated February 3, 2020 be adopted.

Amendment #1

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7 of the General Government Operating Budget Report be amended to remove the part time Community Development Assistant position from the 2020 Operating Budget and that the budget be reduced by $19,300.

CARRIED.

RECORDED VOTE:

In favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Khan, Councillor Tyler Morin

Opposed: Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Lee, Regional Councillor Dies

Amendment #2

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the wording of the 2020 Budget New/Expanded Programs & Initiatives Recreation and Culture – Community Cultural Development Expansion of Festival & Events Program be amended to:

i) Replace the words "would include" with the words "may include" in paragraph 1; and
ii) Replace "Lumina Ajax/Buskerfest" with "Community Events".

CARRIED

RECORDED VOTE:

In favour: Mayor Collier, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Khan, Councillor Tyler Morin

Opposed: Regional Councillor Lee, Regional Councillor Dies

Members discussed the impact of using the Stabilization Reserve to mitigate pressure of the tax rate and asked questions relating to whether other municipalities have followed the same practice, and past use of the Town's Stabilization Reserve. Members discussed whether to spread the impact of the 'ARC exception' increase over two years or move ahead with the full increase.

S. Serrao, Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer responded to questions from the Committee, acknowledging the criteria for use of the Stabilization Reserve could include mitigating an excessive tax increase. She indicated that the last time the Stabilization Reserve was used was during the 2013 Ice Storm. CAO Baker noted that other municipalities have used a Tax Stabilization Reserve in the past to mitigate high tax rate increases.

Amendment #3

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Item 7 of the GGC Report be amended to reflect the following change:

That the Stabilization Reserve be used to phase in the 2.19% Audley Recreation Centre (ARC) Phase 2 exception over two years to soften the tax rate increase burden;

That $744,400, representing 1.09% of the ARC exception be transferred from the Stabilization Reserve to the 2020 Operating Budget; and

That staff be directed to transfer up to $744,400 of the 2019 Operating Budget Surplus to the Stabilization Reserve, and if required, any additional funds be transferred to the Capital Contingency Reserve.

CARRIED

RECORDED VOTE:

In favour: Mayor Collier, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Khan, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin

Opposed: Regional Councillor Dies

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

Council then considered and voted upon the amended recommendation from Item 7 of the GGC Operating Budget report, in which the numbers were adjusted to reflect the impact of the approved amendments.

Item 7 of the GGC Report, as Amended.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the General Government Committee Operating Budget Report dated February 3, 2020 be adopted, including the 2020 Operating Budget, as amended.

2020 Operating Budget	**2020**
2019 General Levy (Property Taxes)	67,341,200
2019 Assessment Growth	946,300
2020 Net Budget Increase	2,619,300
Total General Levy (Property Taxes)	70,906,800

CARRIED

RECORDED VOTE:

In favour: Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Khan, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier.

Opposed: None.

Approval of Item 7.2 - GGC Operating Budget Report

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the General Government Committee Operating Budget Report dated February 3, 2020 be adopted, as amended.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier and Councillor Tyler Morin, 2020 Operating Budget Chair, thanked Town staff and the Treasurer for their work on the budget and discussed increased service levels to be delivered through the 2020 budget.

General Government Committee Report – February 18, 2020

Mayor Collier noted that the February 18, 2020 General Government Committee report had been circulated separately from the agenda.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the General Government Committee Report dated February 18, 2020, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

None

7.4 Departmental Reports

7.4.1 2020 Report on Non-Cash Expenses as Required by Ontario Regulation 284/09

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the report on Excluded Non-Cash Expenses, as required by Ontario Regulation 284/09, be received for information.

CARRIED

7.4.2 Supporting Conservation Authorities Motion

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the motion included in Attachment 1 be endorsed by Council.

CARRIED

Items 7.4.3 and 7.4.4 were addressed earlier in the Meeting.

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillors provided an update regarding matters before the Durham Regional Council including, upcoming 2020 budget discussions, the Durham Regional Police Services Board's strategic business plan, and Durham Region Transit fare increases and fleet additions, including the first autonomous bus. Delegations on behalf of Fridays for Future Whitby and Land Over Landings regarding support for Durham Region's Climate Change Emergency Declaration were noted. An update on the Durham Region Health Department's information campaign to address stigma associated with opioid use disorders, which includes a community video series.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of February 24, 2020 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

None

10. By-laws

None

11. Notice of Motion

None

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities, including a Ward 3 community meeting, St. Francis Centre Trivia Nights, Pickering Casino Information Session, and 100 Men Ajax meeting.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 5-2020 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on February 24, 2020 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the February 24, 2020 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned. (8:26 p.m.)

CARRIED

Mayor

D-Clerk